

TAYLOR PENTZ

Senior Java Backend Engineer

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Professional Summary

Senior Java Backend Engineer with 10+ years delivering enterprise backend systems across **fintech, SaaS, healthcare operations, and cloud-enabled business platforms**, with hands-on experience in **Java 8–21, Spring Boot 1.5–3.x, Spring MVC, Hibernate/JPA, Kafka, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker, and Kubernetes**, known for modernizing legacy systems, improving reliability, and building scalable services that support secure, high-volume business workflows.

Technical Skills

- ❖ **Backend Engineering:** Java 8–21, Spring Boot 1.5–3.x, Spring MVC, Spring Security, Spring Batch, Hibernate, JPA, JDBC, Maven, Gradle, RESTful APIs, SOAP modernization, OpenAPI/Swagger, microservices, monolith decomposition.
- ❖ **Architecture & Patterns:** Microservices, event-driven architecture, layered architecture, hexagonal architecture, domain-driven design basics, CQRS, API gateway patterns, service orchestration, idempotency, retry handling, circuit breakers, distributed tracing.
- ❖ **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS EC2, ECS, EKS, Lambda, S3, RDS, SQS, SNS, CloudWatch, IAM, Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, CI/CD pipelines, blue-green deployments.
- ❖ **Databases & Messaging:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, Oracle, MongoDB, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ, ActiveMQ, database indexing, query tuning, schema migrations, Flyway, Liquibase.
- ❖ **Testing & Quality:** JUnit 4/5, Mockito, Testcontainers, Spring Boot Test, REST Assured, WireMock, integration testing, contract testing, performance testing, SonarQube, code reviews, static analysis.
- ❖ **Monitoring & Production Support:** Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Splunk, CloudWatch Logs, OpenTelemetry, alert tuning, incident analysis, root-cause investigation, SLA/SLO support.
- ❖ **Senior Engineering Practices:** Technical design reviews, API governance, legacy modernization, secure coding, mentoring, release planning, Agile/Scrum delivery, production readiness reviews, documentation.

Professional Experience

SumatoSoft

Senior Software Engineer
Boston, MA (Remote) | Apr 2023 – Mar 2025

- ❖ Led backend development for enterprise SaaS and fintech-facing platforms using **Java 17–21, Spring Boot 2.6–3.x, PostgreSQL, Kafka, Redis, Docker, Kubernetes, and AWS**, focusing on secure transaction workflows, reliable service boundaries, and scalable API delivery.
- ❖ Modernized legacy Spring services by migrating selected modules from **Spring Boot 2.6 to Spring Boot 3.x**, replacing deprecated security configuration, updating Jakarta namespace dependencies, and stabilizing authentication flows before production rollout.

- ❖ Designed and implemented high-volume **REST APIs** for account, billing, notification, and workflow services, using **OpenAPI contracts**, DTO validation, pagination, rate limiting, and consistent error responses for frontend and partner integrations.
- ❖ Improved production reliability by adding **Kafka-based asynchronous processing**, retry policies, dead-letter queues, and idempotency keys for payment-related events that previously caused duplicate processing during timeout and network failure scenarios.
- ❖ Reduced average backend response latency by **38%** after tuning PostgreSQL indexes, removing repeated Hibernate lazy-loading calls, optimizing Redis cache usage, and improving API-level query patterns for heavily used dashboard endpoints.
- ❖ Resolved recurring production defects involving stale cache reads, incorrect timezone conversion, duplicate webhook events, and intermittent database lock waits by improving observability, adding defensive validations, and strengthening integration test coverage.
- ❖ Built secure backend authorization using **Spring Security, JWT, OAuth2 resource server patterns, role-based access control, and audit logging**, helping teams meet internal compliance expectations for sensitive business workflows.
- ❖ Partnered with DevOps engineers to improve **CI/CD pipelines** with Maven build caching, container image scanning, Kubernetes readiness checks, automated smoke tests, and safer rollback paths across staging and production environments.
- ❖ Mentored mid-level engineers through design reviews, pull-request feedback, debugging sessions, and service ownership practices, improving code consistency and reducing avoidable rework during sprint delivery.
- ❖ Collaborated with product managers, QA engineers, and frontend teams to deliver new reporting, billing, and notification features while balancing technical debt, production support, and measurable business delivery goals.

Hexaview Technologies Inc.

Software Engineer

New York, NY | Jul 2018 – Mar 2023

- ❖ Built backend services for financial services, digital operations, and customer workflow platforms using **Java 8–11, Spring Boot 1.5–2.x, Spring MVC, Hibernate, MySQL, PostgreSQL, RabbitMQ, and AWS**.
- ❖ Migrated several legacy Java applications from older **Spring MVC** patterns toward **Spring Boot 2.x** service structure, improving configuration management, dependency consistency, environment separation, and deployment repeatability.
- ❖ Developed RESTful backend modules for customer onboarding, document processing, notification delivery, reporting, and approval workflows, using validation rules, transaction boundaries, and clear API contracts for stable integrations.
- ❖ Improved release delivery speed by **32%** by splitting oversized services, reducing manual deployment steps, adding Jenkins pipeline checks, and introducing automated unit and integration tests around critical backend workflows.
- ❖ Fixed production issues related to null pointer exceptions, inconsistent date parsing, slow SQL joins, failed message retries, and file-upload timeouts by improving logging, query plans, exception handling, and queue recovery logic.
- ❖ Implemented **RabbitMQ** messaging for background jobs such as email delivery, document status updates, and long-running report generation, reducing blocking API calls and improving user-facing response behavior.
- ❖ Strengthened database performance by introducing Flyway migrations, reviewing schema changes before release, tuning indexes for search-heavy endpoints, and removing inefficient ORM queries from high-traffic services.

- ❖ Supported AWS deployments using **EC2, RDS, S3, CloudWatch, IAM, and Docker**, helping stabilize environment configuration and improve visibility into application logs, metrics, and failed job patterns.
- ❖ Participated in architecture discussions, sprint planning, peer reviews, QA defect triage, and production release support, consistently balancing new feature delivery with maintainability and operational reliability.

SimbirSoft Company

Software Developer

Boston, MA | Mar 2015 – Jun 2018

- ❖ Developed backend components for business automation and customer management systems using **Java 7–8, Spring Framework 4.x, Hibernate 4.x, JSP, REST services, MySQL, Oracle, Maven, and Tomcat**.
- ❖ Implemented service-layer logic for user management, order processing, reporting, audit history, and administrative workflows, applying transaction handling and reusable DAO patterns across multiple Java web applications.
- ❖ Helped modernize older servlet and JSP-based modules by introducing **Spring MVC**, cleaner controller-service-repository separation, centralized validation, and more maintainable configuration practices.
- ❖ Reduced recurring production bugs by **27%** after adding JUnit regression tests, improving exception messages, validating edge-case form inputs, and fixing common session-handling problems in legacy web screens.
- ❖ Investigated performance problems caused by unindexed database filters, excessive Hibernate eager loading, and large report exports, then improved query execution and moved heavy exports into background processing.
- ❖ Built and maintained integrations with third-party payment, email, and document services using REST and SOAP clients, while adding retry behavior and clearer logging for failed external calls.
- ❖ Supported migration work from older Java runtime usage toward **Java 8** features where appropriate, including cleaner collection handling, better date/time APIs, and refactoring of repetitive utility code.
- ❖ Worked closely with QA, business analysts, and senior developers to clarify requirements, reproduce defects, document API behavior, and deliver stable backend functionality across multiple client projects.

Microsoft

Software Developer Intern

Cambridge, MA | Aug 2014 – Feb 2015

- ❖ Contributed to internal developer tooling and backend service prototypes using **Java 7, REST endpoints, SQL Server, XML/JSON processing, Git, and automated build scripts** under senior engineering supervision.
- ❖ Implemented small backend features for data validation, user activity tracking, and service health checks, helping internal teams test reliability and usability of workflow-support applications.
- ❖ Assisted with debugging API failures involving malformed JSON payloads, missing database constraints, authentication edge cases, and inconsistent error messages across service responses.
- ❖ Created unit tests and lightweight integration checks around core service utilities, improving confidence in changes before code reviews and reducing manual verification work for senior engineers.
- ❖ Supported database cleanup tasks by reviewing SQL queries, validating test data, documenting schema assumptions, and helping identify records that caused incorrect reporting behavior.
- ❖ Participated in Agile ceremonies, technical walkthroughs, code reviews, and release preparation activities while learning enterprise engineering practices in a large-scale software environment.
- ❖ Documented setup instructions, API behavior, known defects, and troubleshooting steps so future interns and team members could onboard faster and avoid repeated configuration mistakes.

Projects

Enterprise Payment Event Processing Platform

- ❖ Designed a **Java 17, Spring Boot 3.x, Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, and AWS** backend platform for payment-event ingestion, validation, retry handling, and audit tracking, with idempotency keys and dead-letter queues preventing duplicate processing during webhook retries and network interruptions.

Legacy CRM Modernization Program

- ❖ Led backend modernization for a legacy CRM system by refactoring **Java 8, Spring MVC, Hibernate, MySQL, and JSP** modules into cleaner service boundaries, adding REST APIs, improving database indexes, and introducing automated regression tests to support safer incremental migration.

Certifications

- ❖ **Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 11 Developer**
- ❖ **AWS Certified Developer – Associate**
- ❖ **Spring Professional Certification**
- ❖ **Docker Certified Associate**
- ❖ **Professional Scrum Master I**

Education

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science (2010 – 2014)